

Mathieu Bourret Soto

PhD Candidate in Economics

Political Econ. | Behavioral Econ. | Conflicts and Peacebuilding | Climate Change Adaptation

Email: mathieu.bourret@u-bordeaux.fr | Website: <https://mathieubourretsoto.github.io/>

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Bordeaux School of Economics, France 2022-present
Political economy, conflict and peacebuilding; applied empirical research on Latin America.
Supervisors: Mathieu Clément (BxSE), Éric Rougier (BxSE)
Visiting fellow: NOVAFRICA (sponsor: Victoire Girard), Portugal

M.Sc. in Development Economics, University Clermont-Auvergne, France 2020-2022
Major: sustainable development
Erasmus: University of Göttingen, Germany

B.Sc. in Economics, University of Montpellier, France 2016-2019

JOB MARKET PAPER

“*This is our Legacy: Youth Exposure to Repression and Trust in Institutions*” (2026).
Available as a working paper at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4804803>

Abstract. This paper examines how exposure to political repression during youth affects long-term trust in public institutions in Chile, drawing on the impressionable years hypothesis (IYH). Focusing on the 1973 coup and the ensuing 17-year dictatorship, I exploit variation in proximity to pre-1970 military bases as a proxy for local repression intensity. The results indicate that individuals who were in their critical period (ages 17-25) at the time of the 1973 coup exhibit significantly lower trust in the *Carabineros* (national police) decades later, with similarly negative effects observed for those who were 10-16 at the time. By contrast, trust in representative institutions (the government and the presidency) is not significantly affected, indicating institution-specific legacies. I also consider potential channels such as migration history, university attendance, and residence in the capital, finding no evidence that these factors moderate the results. Overall, the findings show that early-life exposure to repression can durably erode institutional trust, underscoring the long shadow of political violence on democratic consolidation.

PUBLICATIONS

“Prevalence and factors associated with the adoption of heat-adaptive behaviors among residents of a French southern region”, with Marlène Guillon *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 109(102883), 2026.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jenvp.2025.102883>

“What drives adaptive behaviours during heatwaves? A systematic review with a meta-analysis”, with Marlène Guillon. *Climate Policy*, 24(8), 2024.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/14693062.2024.2388225>

ONGOING WORK

Political Economy and Conflict

“Grassroots Institutions and Selective Violence: Evidence from Communal Action Boards in Colombia.”

“Reunited? Post-conflict attitudes toward former FARC”, with Thibaut Plassot-Sansans.

“Fear of Crime in Latin America’s secondary cities: a mixed methods approach”, with Matthieu Clément and Thibaut Plassot-Sansans.

“Fear beyond the metropolis: Insecurity imaginaries and perceptions of security policies in Latin America’s secondary cities”, with Matthieu Clément, Sébastien Cuenot, Thibaut Plassot-Sansans and Eric

Rougier.

Environmental and Health Economics

“Preferences for arboviruses prevention programs: A discrete choice experiment among French residents of southern France”, with Marlène Guillon.

“Understanding Individual Adaptation to Arboviral Diseases Risk: A Systematic Review of Behavioural Determinants of Prevention and Meta-Analysis for non-tropical countries”, with Elisa Delor and Marlène Guillon.

RECENT ACADEMIC WORK EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant , University of Bordeaux	
<i>Mathematical Tools & Inferential Statistics</i>	2024
<i>Computer Science</i>	2023
Research Assistant , University of Montpellier	2022

CONFERENCES

BxSE Doctoral Seminars , Bordeaux, France	2026
Workshop on Ibero-American Development , Göttingen, Germany	2025
EEA 2025 , Bordeaux, France	2025
Nova SBE PhD Research Group , Lisbon, Portugal	2025
2nd WAP Conference , Bordeaux, France	2025
IT18 Winter School , Canazei, Italy	2025
BxSE Doctoral Seminars , Bordeaux, France	2024
WAPLAC Workshop #1 , San José, Costa Rica	2024
AFEDEV Doctoral Days , Paris, France	2024
45th JESF Conference , Bordeaux, France	2023
BxSE Doctoral Seminars , Bordeaux, France	2023

PEER REVIEW EXPERIENCE

Journal of Environmental Psychology, Frontiers in Psychiatry

RESEARCH FUNDING

IdEx “Investments for the Future” fund & Grand Programme de Recherche HOPE , University of Bordeaux / French State	2022–2026
University of Bordeaux Graduate Research Support (UBGRS) , Research visit funding (NOVAFRICA, Nova SBE, Lisbon)	2025
CHANGES Doctoral Research Grant , University of Bordeaux – doctoral research support grant	2023

LANGUAGES

French (Mother tongue), English (Proficient), Spanish (Conversational)